

DAL by 3.2

61%



DAL win 61% · pick'em (0) · POR win 39%

Shaded area each side of pick'em = each team's win chance; dark tick = our call.

Projected score POR 80 — DAL 82 · Total 171

Read

DAL is a slight favorite (61% to win).

- DAL is a slight favorite here (61% to win); we project **DAL 82, POR 80**.
- Projected as a higher-scoring game (total near **171**).
- Availability: **POR** without S. Feagin (1 OUT); **DAL** 2 GTD (A. Smith, P. Bueckers) — OUT players are excluded from the box; the minutes of any projected among them are redistributed into the rotation below.
- How sure: 4 games in 5 the **DAL** margin lands between **-13** and **+21** (+ = DAL ahead) — single games swing a lot, and even so DAL loses outright about 39% of the time.

Injuries & availability — out of the projected box

TEAM	PLAYER	STATUS / CAUSE	GAMES MISSED	EXP. RETURN
DAL	Alanna Smith	Day-to-day · leg	2	Jul 22
DAL	Paige Bueckers	Day-to-day · rest	1	Jul 22
POR	Sania Feagin	Knee	9	TBD

Cause read from the injury feed's report; games missed = the team's games played since the player last appeared; expected return as reported ('TBD' = no date given).

Players to watch

Each side's top two projected scorers — biggest game-changer first (impact = points added vs an average player); the % is the team's scoring each carries.

- DAL** **P. Bueckers** 17 pts (20% of DAL's scoring) / 4 reb / 5 ast in 29 min · +1.2 impact · **J. Shepard** 11 pts (13% of DAL's scoring) / 9 reb / 3 ast in 26 min · +0.2 impact
- POR** **B. Carleton** 10 pts (13% of POR's scoring) / 4 reb / 2 ast in 26 min · +0.7 impact · **C. Leite** 13 pts (17% of POR's scoring) / 2 reb / 5 ast in 23 min · +0.1 impact

Projected box

Big # = jersey · bold above the line = projected starters (top-5 minutes) · IMPACT = points added vs an average player per 100 possessions (— = not yet rated).

Source: per-slate minutes + player-rate projections, availability-adjusted (minutes → 200, points scaled to the simulation score).

DAL

#	PLAYER	IMPACT	MIN	PTS	REB	AST	3PM
5	P. Bueckers (GTD 0.55)	+1.2	28.7	16.6	3.9	5.1	1.2
35	A. Fudd	+1.2	26.9	10.4	2.2	2.0	1.6
32	J. Shepard	+0.2	26.5	11.0	8.7	3.4	0.1
24	A. Ogunbowale	-1.0	21.8	9.1	2.1	1.7	1.2
30	H. Jones	-0.2	16.5	6.5	3.4	1.4	0.4
34	A. Kuier	+0.1	11.9	3.7	2.3	0.7	0.4
—	J. Quinerly thin sample	-0.2	9.9	3.8	1.0	1.3	0.5

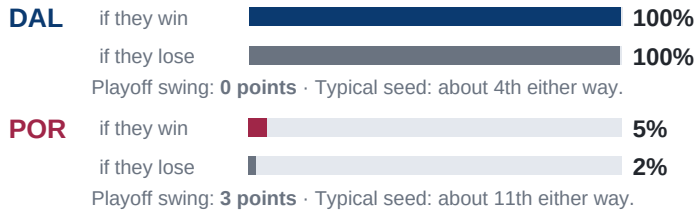
#	PLAYER	IMPACT	MIN	PTS	REB	AST	3PM
28	L. Yueru	+0.3	9.5	3.6	3.0	0.6	0.4
20	M. Siegrist	+0.5	8.1	2.9	1.3	0.4	0.3
8	A. Smith (GTD 0.55)	+1.0	7.9	2.8	1.7	0.3	0.3
1	O. Sims	-0.6	7.5	2.9	0.6	1.1	0.3
10	A. James	+0.2	7.0	3.3	1.2	0.8	0.3
0	S. Sutton	-0.2	6.7	2.2	0.5	0.9	0.3
7	A. Clark	-1.9	6.7	1.9	0.9	0.5	0.3
6	C. Verona G · 5'7" · thin sample	-0.0	4.4	1.7	0.6	0.6	0.2
	Team		200.0	82.4			

POR

#	PLAYER	IMPACT	MIN	PTS	REB	AST	3PM
6	B. Carleton	+0.7	25.5	10.2	3.9	2.0	1.9
0	C. Leite	+0.1	23.0	13.4	2.2	5.0	0.8
17	M. Gustafson	+0.5	22.9	9.5	3.8	1.4	1.1
3	S. Ashlee Barker	-0.6	22.5	8.8	3.8	1.9	1.1
21	E. Engstler	+1.3	20.6	7.3	5.3	2.5	0.9
20	F. Buhner	-0.1	12.3	4.7	2.1	0.9	0.7
44	K. Samuelson	+0.0	11.1	3.4	1.0	0.8	0.7
13	N. Puoch	-0.2	10.5	3.1	1.2	0.7	0.5
—	K. Smalls thin sample	+0.8	10.2	4.0	0.7	1.6	0.7
15	L. Geiselsoder	+0.4	9.6	3.3	1.8	0.7	0.5
7	T. Oblak	+0.5	8.8	3.9	1.0	1.2	0.6
25	S. Williams	+0.4	8.2	3.0	1.6	0.4	0.1
2	J. Harrison	-0.0	7.8	3.0	1.1	1.6	0.2
77	H. Winterburn	-1.9	7.0	2.6	0.7	1.1	0.4
	Team		200.0	80.2			

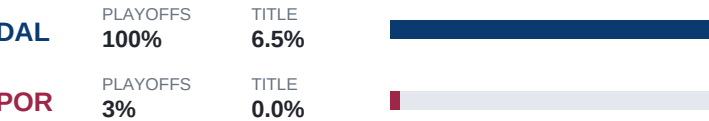
A deeper look
What tonight means

A win tonight puts **POR**'s playoff chances at **5%** — a loss drops them to **2%**.
Across both teams that makes this the **4th-biggest playoff-swing game** of this week's 6 remaining games.



Source: the rest of the season replayed 10,000 times, split by tonight's result (may differ from the headline odds by a fraction of a point — same simulation, different run counts).

Season odds — playoffs & title



Source: live 1M-run season simulation (the board's odds core).

Starting-five skill profiles

5 P. Bueckers



35 A. Fudd

No prior-season skill data yet (first WNBA season)

32 J. Shepard



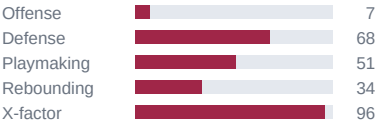
24 A. Ogunbowale



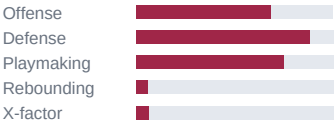
30 H. Jones



6 B. Carleton



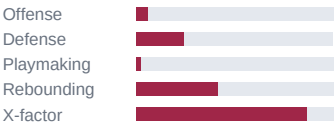
0 C. Leite



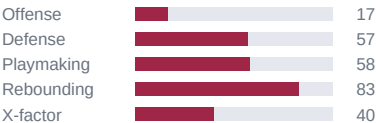
17 M. Gustafson



3 S. Ashlee Barker



21 E. Engstler



Source: league-percentile bars from each player's most recent full-season profile (the 2025 season); first-year players have none yet. Estimated from public play-by-play.

Appendix — how the numbers are made

- Scores, totals & the margin distribution = a 1M-run Monte-Carlo simulation; spread = regression + home recalibration; the margin curve & ranges are calibrated intervals (~89% observed coverage at the 90% target); playoff leverage = the season replayed 10,000 times, split by tonight's result.
- Player values = per-minute rates (last-10-games form → season → positional average) × projected minutes, team points scaled to the simulation total. Minutes = per-slate projection + injury redistribution under per-player caps — OUT players removed and their minutes reallocated (box sums to 200; a "provisional" team has rotation players missing from tonight's model, so its box shows only the modeled minutes and is not inflated).
- Some player-level estimates lean on the limited public play-by-play for this league; richer tracking data would sharpen them.

THE SEASON SO FAR (through 998 games): Our spread calls miss by an average of 10.8 points · when we make a team a 60%+ favorite, they win 68% of the time · player minutes within +/-6.0, points within +/-3.9 (player lines: reconstructed day-before for all 143 games; live tracking began Jul 8.)
Recent monthly accuracy (average miss, lower is better): May '25 9.9 · Jun '25 10.7 · Jul '25 11.7 · Aug '25 10.0 · Sep '25 10.3 · May '26 11.1 · Jun '26 10.6 · Jul '26 12.2 points.
all-games: spread +/-10.8 · minutes +/-6.0 · points +/-3.8

Generated 2026-07-22T15:05:49Z · report of record. Built by The Hardwood from existing production models — no new models and no hand-entered numbers. Full methodology and sources are in this game's companion notes.